

MICKLEHAM PARISH Magazine

A community magazine for Mickleham and Westhumble



October 2026

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MICKLEHAM PARISH Magazine

**October
2026**

**Mickleham
Parish
Magazine**

A community magazine for
Mickleham and Westhumble
published under the auspices
of Mickleham PCC with an
independent editorial panel.

The magazine is published at the
beginning of each month except
January and August.

COPY DEADLINE

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**Sunday
11th October**

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Mickleham Rectory

Dear all

I am writing in early September and looking ahead to October when you will (hopefully) read this. I am currently very grateful for the rain that we have had and am amazed at how in just a week or so shoots of green grass are visible when a few days before it looked dead. It seems to symbolise hope; amid apparent barrenness there maybe life. For some plants the rain came too late, and they have not survived the drought or are unable to produce good fruit. Predictions suggest that the harvest of various crops will not be so good this year. I have noted much poorer quality blackberries and much of the fruit, salad and cereal crops have been affected. And yet there will still be food for me to buy in the shops. For some, although food is available, they cannot afford to buy. As we approach harvest time it is important to be thankful for what we can enjoy and remember that we are privileged as many go without. It is good to be grateful for all the hard work that lies behind what we eat and to be aware of the struggles of farmers to cope with extremes of climate both in this country and elsewhere. Part of that thankfulness can be expressed as generosity towards those with less. As usual our Harvest Thanksgiving service will provide opportunity to thank God for all he has provided and to support the work of Dorking Foodbank and the Meeting Room in Leatherhead.

Paul uses a phrase in Galatians 6 which comes from farming. This Biblical phrase is probably familiar: a man will reap what he sows. We may use this critically when we can see someone is laying the foundations of a disaster, but Paul is being positive and reminding us that there is reward in doing good. He follows on with 'Let us not become weary in doing good'. The reward can be of knowing we have helped someone, of receiving gratitude, of feeling we have contributed to the well-being of a community, of receiving kindness when things have become tough for us. Paul was also suggesting it is good for our souls and our relationship with God to focus on the needs of others and look beyond ourselves. We can give up being generous. when we feel hard done by or are struggling in some way which can cause our focus to shift solely onto ourselves. Sometimes we stop doing good if there is an overwhelming amount of need and our small contribution seems insignificant, but how much better it is to keep going. The metaphor used by Paul of sowing seed suggests there will be a crop one day and what we do and what we give will bear fruit, even if it is far into the future.

Finally, I encourage you to come to our Harvest Thanksgiving service on 4th October at 11 am when we will be collecting non-perishable food or monetary donations. There will be a craft workshop beforehand for children, and all are welcome to stay for a light lunch and glass of wine afterwards.

God Bless



The Rev'd Dr Sandra Faccini, Parish Priest

The school service on 5th July can be found at <https://youtu.be/YoB2zKreDjA>

Please see details of the children's Harvest Workshop on page 3.

St Michael's Church Services

10 am Sunday Services available on Zoom

Joining information for both Zoom and telephone users is available in Pews News Online each week. If you would like to join us by Zoom then contact Alison Wood for the codes or to ask her to include you on the emailing list for Pews News: admin@micklehamchurch.org.uk / phone 01372 376443. We hope as many of you as possible will be able to join us for worship.

Please refer to Pews News Online for the latest information. If you missed any of the services or would like to revisit them all are available on the church YouTube channel: <https://youtube.com/channel/UCI4pbewCT91iZhcd0EjJB1w>



Men's and Women's Breakfasts

9-10 am at the Stepping Stones pub

WOMEN'S BREAKFAST
3RD SATURDAY OF THE MONTH
NEXT BREAKFAST

17TH OCTOBER

Book with:

Stephanie Randall
srandall55@gmail.com

MEN'S BREAKFAST
4TH SATURDAY OF THE MONTH
NEXT BREAKFAST

24TH OCTOBER

Book with:

Andy Diamond
adiamond714@gmail.com



At Westhumble Chapel

Monday evening group

7.45 pm till 9 pm

Please contact Amanda on aewadsworth@hotmail.com if you would like more information.

Thursday morning group

11 am for an 11.30 start until 12.30 pm

If you would like to join us, please call Alison Wood on 01372 376443 or 07905 985928.



First Saturday of the month
Coffee Morning
Westhumble Chapel

Saturday 3rd October

Come along between 10 am and 12 noon
Coffee and cake £2 Free drinks for children
Everyone welcome

For further information call Jonathan Blake 07787 126966



Tea @ 3

Monday 19th October

Host: Alison Wood
Abbots Cottage, London Road, Mickleham

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St Michael's Church Community Group Food Bank Collection

We welcome items for adults, children and infants including:

- non-perishable food
- laundry and cleaning supplies
- personal hygiene products

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MICKLEHAM

Garden Corner off Old London Road
Mary Banfield 01372 373912

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St Anthony Pilgrims Way
Sue Tatham 01306 882547

The Stepping Stones
Westhumble Street



Also items may be brought to Coffee Mornings at Westhumble Chapel and St Michael's Church on Sunday mornings

To make monetary donations go to: <https://dorkingarea.foodbank.org.uk/give-help/donate-money/>

CHECK THE COMMUNITY WHATSAPP EACH WEEK FOR ITEMS CURRENTLY IN SHORT SUPPLY

St Michael's Community Group



Harvest appeal 2026

The harvest period is a key time for the foodbank, and it is where stocks are hopefully built up to cope with the increasing demand as the colder weather draws in.

So please support our neighbours during this critical time and watch out for the weekly updates on what is most needed. I am sure we can do even better than we did last year with your help.

Kelvin Pritchard,
St Michael's Community Group

Worship in the great outdoors

The first service of every month is always a family service without communion and usually with a fun activity for both children and adults alike. For September, a tent in the Rectory garden was a perfect location for an environmental themed service celebrating the wonderful natural world and beautiful area in which we are very fortunate to live.

David Kennington, Ecogroup chair, updated us on work in managing the special grassland, the seasonal pond, maintaining and improving the laid hedges and generally trying to improve the biodiversity of the churchyard. St Michael's is part of the A Rocha scheme which promotes environmental awareness and responsibility in churches and the ecogroup has applied for a gold award which will surpass the silver award achieved two years ago. Watch this space! Additional volunteers are always welcome when we have a working party and you do not have to go to church to lend a hand.

Tim Mathieson shared information about a very worthwhile charity called Five Talents which provides microfinance to areas in Africa and helps, often women, to start and develop small

Autumn Lunches: All Welcome

We have two lunches, Thursday 22nd October and Thursday 26th November at the Mickleham Village Hall. Doors open at 12.45 pm, and lunch will be served from 1 pm.

Places are going quickly. There is no charge, but donations will be gratefully received, with all proceeds going to local charities (including the Foodbank).

To help us plan quantities, please book your place with Andy Diamond



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businesses. This gives people a hand up rather than a hand out and Tim urged us to consider using savings that we might make through our own improved energy usage or other more eco-friendly lifestyle choices to give to Five Talents. Their website explains their ethos and has some interesting examples of how life changing a little financial loan can be. www.fivetalents.org.uk

Sandra, our priest, loves a fun game and this time it was creating a food web. The choir were volunteered to be a range of creatures and plants, from a tiny aphid to an apex predator fox and had to connect themselves with a ball of string. The web did become quite tangled! But the point is that we are all interdependent. We need the tiniest creatures from micro-organisms upwards to sustain life. Biodiversity is important! We inhabit a wonderful planet which we need to look after better and Sandra's message is that we can all make a difference.

Having sung uplifting hymns, accompanied by Beverly on the

keyboard, in glorious sunshine in the lovely setting of the Rectory garden, we enjoyed coffee and homemade cake. Another special Mickleham moment!

Lucy Adshead

Harvest Festival Workshop

Sunday 4th October
10 - 11 am

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Our Disappearing 'Common' Birds

While some are clinging on, many of the birds we used to see and hear on a daily basis, are really struggling, particularly in the South-East. Only a few years ago, on warm evenings above Mickleham, the sky would be full of feeding house martins and swallows. I cannot comment on Westhumble, but in Mickleham, there have been precious few of either for the last several summers. Greenfinches and chaffinches have been decimated, both by disease, and more generic factors. Nuthatch and woodpecker numbers are down. Have you heard the song of a willow warbler for the last few years, or indeed, a cuckoo? Even blackbird and house sparrow and the various tit numbers are significantly down. It is many years since I saw a swift in our villages, and the once screeching flocks in Dorking seem to be significantly reduced. And starlings, once so common that a birdwatcher would hardly raise a binocular, are now a subject of conversation.

In Surrey, there seems to be widespread agreement that the number of 'farmland' birds are down by 25% since 2010, closely followed by woodland species (19%). Nationally, and over a

longer period, these numbers are down an alarming 60% and 30% respectively over 50 years. And some species, such as yellowhammer, willow tit and lapwing are down over 90%. These, and other species are now 'fringe species', only to be seen in specific habitats.

And its not just birds! You will have all appreciated the lower number of insects, generally. No point in arguing that the lower number of insects on our windscreens are due to car aerodynamics. Some 20 years ago, if you sat outside the Runners, eating, you would be hugely bothered by wasps. Now? Where are those pesky woodlice? And grasshoppers? Whole ecosystems appear to be in decline: the common toad and the adder are endangered in Surrey. A few bats remain, whereas my loft is empty, having had more than 100 in 2006.

The ecological picture in the South-East is indeed depressing. And more worrying, there is no wholly agreed or single identified cause. With birds, there are diseases about, there is habitat loss, climate change, there is a cleaner farming/urban society and so on. But a factor which is increasingly

coming to the fore, is the multitude of combined factors, to be summed up as 'human pressure', including all these other factors, but also the sheer number of other effects that high density populations have, spreading outwards from the major centres.

Rewilding may go some way for slowing down the process, but again, only locally. Re-introduction of species may well help, but while there is good press on the assistance for 'glamorous' species, such as Sallowtail butterflies, beavers, boar, Sea eagles and kites. Where are the efforts related to the insects and less visible creatures?

We humans tend to think that we are somehow distinct, apart from, or indeed superior to, the rest of the Earth's ecology. The dinosaurs were the last example of this, and look what happened to them. As a species, the massive pressure for new human 'nests' and 'territories' is gradually eliminating those of all our earthly co-inhabitants. The human race will no doubt outlast other 'life-forms' on the planet due to ingenuity. But co-existence with an otherwise lifeless world is surely not a great outlook.

Mark Day Non-activist, more realist
Lecture over!

Mickleham Children's Playground

After more than 10 years heading up the Mickleham Children's Playground Association, Sarah Parfitt has stepped down as chair. We would like to thank her for all her hard work and being the driving force behind the fantastic playground you see today.

Erin Olivier of School Lane has taken over the role. Any queries, concerns or if you wish to become a volunteer for the Association, please contact her on 07851 997 427 or at micklehamplayground@gmail.com

Historically, the role of treasurer has

been linked with St Michael's school. Due to the sad closure of the school, we are recruiting a new treasurer for the committee to shadow the existing one before she steps down next year. It is a very straight forward role and will not require much of your time. Please contact Erin if you are interested.



Westhumble Bonfire 7th November

Dates for bonfire building and timing on the night- see page 27.

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A Very Special Wedding at St Michael's Church

On Saturday, 22nd August 2026, our family had the enormous pleasure of celebrating the wedding of our daughter Jade Butcher to her husband Keelan Hartnett.

It was a truly wonderful and memorable day, surrounded by Jade's family, the Butchers from Mickleham and Keelan's family, the Hartnetts who flew all the way from Australia, together with friends and loved ones. There was something especially meaningful about seeing Jade and her husband Keelan begin their married life together in such a beautiful and familiar setting at the heart of our local community.

As proud parents, it was an emotional and joyous day for us, and one that we will treasure forever. We would like to thank everyone at St Michael's Church who helped make the occasion so special with special thanks to Reverend Sandra Faccini for a wonderful service.



Jade and Keelan now begin the next exciting chapter of their lives together, taking with them many wonderful memories of a truly perfect day.

Thanks also go to the Running Horses who provided accommodation food and drink for all the travelling Aussies, our friends and family.

With love and gratitude from a very proud Butcher family.

Note the dates: Services in November

November 8th is Remembrance Sunday. The service will start at 10 am, and we will gather at the war memorial in the churchyard at 11 am. There will be no Holy Communion service that day at church or at the Chapel.

On Sunday November 15th there is a Lights to Remember service at 4 pm when we remember our loved ones who are no longer with us.



The Solar Eclipse: An Extraordinary Event

contradiction: hundreds of people drawn towards a beautiful natural landscape in order to experience a natural event, while vehicles crowd the road running through it.

There is something worth thinking about in that image. For all our technology, buildings, screens and increasingly urban lives, when something truly extraordinary happens in the natural world, many of us instinctively want to experience it in nature. We do not necessarily want to watch it through a window or on a telephone. We want the hill, the

horizon, the changing light, the trees and the open sky.

That should tell us something about the value of the green spaces that remain. These places are not empty. A hill such as Box Hill can look spacious enough to absorb almost anything. It cannot. A natural landscape is not empty ground waiting to accommodate whatever we bring to it. It is a living system. Trees, grassland, woodland edges, insects, birds, bats and mammals occupy the same landscape that we experience as visitors. They are living habitats: places where other species feed, breed, shelter and survive.

Box Hill is also a refuge for people. We increasingly ask our remaining countryside to do an extraordinary number of things at once. We want somewhere to walk, cycle, picnic, exercise, socialise, learn, find quiet, watch wildlife and, occasionally, stand together and watch the moon pass across the sun.

Those demands are not necessarily incompatible but they do require stewardship. The rarer these places become, the more carefully we should treat them. They are not spare land. They are not simply attractive backgrounds to our lives. They are places we instinctively turn to for wonder, perspective, quiet, help and connection.

For a tiny part of one evening, something else happened. Hundreds of car engines were switched off. People put down what they were doing and looked upwards, nature hushed. The landscape seemed to become quieter. Yet even during that brief moment, some chose to fill that soundscape with engines: weaving through parked vehicles, revving and accelerating around local roads – antisocial motorcyclists.

This is not an argument against motorcycles or cars. It is a question about what we want our remaining natural places to be.

Quiet is an overlooked natural resource: easily lost, difficult to restore, and increasingly precious in the few places where people and wildlife can still experience it.

Access matters. But access should not mean that every road through every beautiful landscape must always accommodate unrestricted traffic. There should be moments and places where we are prepared to close a road, reduce vehicles, protect tranquillity and allow people to walk, cycle, listen and simply be there. Access for residents, emergency services and those who need vehicles can of course be preserved.

The eclipse reminded us that these landscapes are deeply wanted. Perhaps we should honour that. If hundreds of people will travel to a hill simply to stand together for an hour and look at the sky, then our remaining green spaces are not luxuries.

We need them.

And things that are both precious and increasingly rare deserve exceptional care. We cannot keep flying elsewhere to witness nature at its best; we need to protect and nurture what remains here, and give nature the space to recover and grow back.

Sometimes that might mean allowing a road to become quiet enough for nature to be the main event.

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KING WILLIAM IV

Dear friends & neighbours,

We ended the summer on a high with some lovely events for neighbour's family celebrations
and a warm September.

Now we are well and truly in Autumn. Our lovely cosy interior has new tartan curtains courtesy of Anne, and our
snuggly log burner. Kat is working her magic on warming Autumn fayre and our famous Sunday roasts.

We hope to see you soon Eamonn, Kat and Anne x

Byttom Hill Mickleham 01372 372590 www.thekingwilliamiv.com

An unwelcome discovery

One thing leads to another... or the churchwardens make an unwelcome discovery.

Towards the end of 2025, an eagle-eyed member of the church flower arranging team noticed that the tomb in the Norbury Chapel was looking somewhat distressed and shedding friable debris. Closer inspection revealed salts leaching out of the soft Reigate stone. This was not good news! Even closer inspection revealed active woodworm in the wooden panelling in the Norbury Chapel which was even worse news.

As you can imagine, looking after the fabric of a grade 2 listed building is a bit like painting the Forth Bridge as there is a seemingly endless list of things that need attention. Some jobs can be left to wait and see what happens but this was clearly not in that category. First things first, the woodworm had to be treated which was swiftly done. But why the other problems? This is where we needed to call upon the expertise and experience of Chris Anstey of Anstey & Stone, a very knowledgeable and experienced stonemason who has undertaken repairs at St Michael's for decades.

On a very cold January day, Chris came to take a look and quickly diagnosed the cause of the problem: damp! Our exceptionally wet winter had caused the lower part of the external wall to the Norbury chapel to become extremely wet and the damp had tracked inwards to the tomb and the panelling, making the stone friable and the wood soft (just how woodworms like it!). The true culprit of the damp was modern mortar made from sand and cement which had been used at some point in the past to repair the lower part of the outside

flint wall and was trapping moisture inside the wall. Old buildings need to breathe and they need to be restored and repaired using the correct materials which in this case was lime mortar.

Work began in August and involved removing all the flints and chipping off all the modern mortar which revealed that the inside of the wall was still wet (not just damp!) even after we had experienced the hottest summer ever recorded. The wall has now been rebuilt using traditional lime mortar and

a lead sill has been inserted to deflect rainwater away from the building which has now been put to the test with some proper rainfall. It is a joy to behold! The tomb has also received some TLC to stabilise the damage sustained.

It will take several years for the wall to dry out but, with breathable material now where it should be, we are hopeful that any further internal damage will cease and that this area of the church will now be stable for many years to come.

Lucy Adshead



Rubbish at the Station

This is the result of David Farmery's approach to Southern Trains, published in the September issue of this magazine, about litter on Box Hill and Westhumble railway station:

Hi David,

Thank you for your email.

Following assessment, a decision to re-instate the bins at Box Hill and

Westhumble has been made in relation to footfall and waste generated at the station.

We have had approval to remove one parking space to accommodate the required Biffa bins and Biffa have also confirmed that they are able to service the location.

There is still some work to be done

before this can take place, so we kindly ask for your patience in the meantime whilst work in the background takes place. We anticipate approximately six weeks for final completion.

Kind regards,

Laura Hamlet
HQ Customer Relations

Watch this space!

Save this Date for the Village Fete:

Saturday 3rd July 2027

Good news, an events committee has been created and are working on the Village Fete for next year! More news and how to get involved to follow.

A Bittersweet Celebration of St Michael's School: Part 2

In Part 1 we read memories of St Michael's School from former head teachers Jenny Hudlass and Anne Hossack and from Pat Hand, long time school governor including time as chair of Governors. Part 2 covers the history of the school from 1843 to 1960 and up-to-date. We hope to continue with Part 3 next month with warm and sometimes funny memories from former pupils.

In 1843 the first purpose-built school in Mickleham opened its doors on a site nestled between Byttom Hill and what is now the modern A24 bypass. Records show that the building which included an attached headmaster's house, was entirely funded by public subscription. Today the original 1843 structure still stands, having been converted into two private residences known as *The Old School House* and *The Old School Cottage*.

Functioning as a Church of England National School, it was designed to give a basic, religious-leaning education to the children of the parish's working poor. It focussed firmly on the 3R's alongside mandatory scripture lessons. At first the attendance averaged around 40, but this figure increased as the years went by.

Like many rural Victorian institutions, day-to-day attendance was heavily disrupted by the local farming calendar. Children frequently skipped lessons to work the land, assisting with local tasks like crow scaring, cattle herding and beating during the grouse shoot.

The school's punishment book shows that 1-4 strokes of the cane were inflicted on either hand or posterior for, among other things idleness, cheating, lying and laughter. In one account it was administered for 'misbehaviour on parade by syringing water over a girl in the playground'. The logbook recorded a child reporting black smoke coming from the direction of the Almshouses, only to be rebuked by the schoolmaster. Later it was discovered that the Almshouses were indeed on fire. Towards the end of the 19th century there were 89 pupils on the register, but the work of the school had been 'very

much impeded by ringworm, influenza, whooping cough and measles'.

At the turn of the 20th century the county education authorities declared that the school premises were unsuitable and did not have a playground. On July 26th 1907, the Bishop of Dorking laid the foundation stone, for a new school. The approach to the school would be by a new road cut through from School Hill to provide access to the site. This road was called School Lane from its inception. The building committee launched an appeal for public subscriptions towards the cost of the new school. The estimate total cost of the new road, the building and its furnishings was between £2,500 and £3,000. Some of this expenditure was recovered by the sale of the old school.

In 1908 the new building opened its doors and took over the village's primary education duties. It could accommodate 120 children: 84 mixed and 36 infants and remains the core of the school we know today.

Photographic evidence and historical records confirm that there was a large area of allotments located directly behind the school (to the east). However, they were not a part of the school's layout when it first opened in 1908. Instead, they appeared a decade later due to the major food crisis caused by German submarine activities during the First World War.

Both World Wars naturally interrupted the pupils' education. In the first, the children were called upon to help the war effort by collecting horse chestnuts for munitions. In both wars several teachers were called up for military service. Entries in 1940 the school logs show that attendance was hit by daily air

Top: the school in 1907; above: the school in 1960;

raids, and frequent gas mask drills took place. During the '40s wartime evacuees from Peckham and Dulwich joined local families, they were accompanied by their teacher Mr Maybe, who organised the construction of an air raid shelter north of the school built by the pupils. The boys dug for victory and the girls knitted various comforts for soldiers and airmen.

In 1948 Headmaster Charles Webb began his 12-year tenure at the school. His logs reflect the challenges of post-war England: reconstruction, the implementation of the landmark Education Act 1944, and the arrival of the baby boomer generation. Under his leadership, the school served children from Mickleham, Westhumble, and the surrounding areas (including children who were bussed or coached down from Box Hill) before they transitioned to secondary schools in nearby Dorking.

Ian Dennis, a much-loved local resident and pupil at the school, wrote *Mr Webb had a love of gardening and part of the grounds were divided into four vegetable plots with a pond in the middle. Everyone enjoyed the pond, even a few fell in, no injuries, just a little wet. If the afternoon was fine, we would all be tending the vegetables.*



Top: Mickleham New National School engraving
Above: The mobile classroom 1964 to 2014

THE SCHOOL AFTER 1960

The 1960s marked the peak era of pupil enrolment for the school under headmaster Charles Webb. The post-WWII 'baby boom' coupled with the expanding local populations of Mickleham and Westhumble filled the building to its maximum functional capacity. Children walked down to the village hall for lunch. In 1964 the temporary mobile classroom was erected within the school grounds. This was not dismantled until 2014. During the 1960s, Mickleham School (now known as St Michael's) operated as a bustling, multi-class village school with a total pupil population



averaging 60-90 pupils.

For the church service a group of former St Michael's headteachers, governors, parents and pupils related their experiences at the school. We hope to include some of them in the next issue.
Sue Tatham

The Final Match of the Season MCC vs Coldharbour

This report of MCC's final match for the 2026 season rivals any report from the Test Match Special team on BBC radio. Kevin captures the atmospheric setting of the Coldharbour cricket field followed by fast-paced description of the fast-paced action on the field. I was not there, but the report made me wish I had been.
Editor

The setting was fabulous for our last game of cricket of the season and what a great team to play against.

The rain had stayed away, the ground was perfect and captain Fantastic won the toss and elected to field.

Coldharbour's cricket field is set in the pristine Surrey forest and is smaller than most fields. The outfield was fast and a battle royale ensued between the opening bowlers and batsmen. Arthur and Kevin managed to curtail the initial onslaught, Arthur seven overs one for

34 and Kevin seven overs one for 35. Freddie, Ali and Peter held the middle overs together although the scoring was free and steady. Bertie and Justin bowled the last 11 overs together and did a sterling job to contain the run scoring. There were some fantastic catches from Ollie and Arthur and one tremendous drop catch from the Captain Kevin (very disappointing and resulting in Chapter six (Catching Masterclass) of the upcoming book being scrapped). Coldharbour finished their innings on a very impressive 293.

They produced a tea to rival the famous MCC tea: burgers and chips. Peter brought his scotch eggs and our energy was restored.

Ollie and Justin opened the batting and what followed was a batting masterclass. Both looked like they were having so much fun as they smashed

the ball to all parts of the park. Justin smashed 18 fours on his way to a fast 87 and Ollie three sixes and nine fours to his equally fast 66. Nick P making his return to fine form smashed 35 in at three. This foundation set the platform up for a remarkable effort from the MCC youth. Arthur 43 not out and Bertie 20 crucial runs, with four fours off his mate Hugo brought us to the brink of winning. Bertie lost his wicket and in stepped the calm strong courageous Ali. We needed six to win off two balls, Ali to face. Smash Ali's first ball goes for four. The tension was high, two runs to win. Ali hit a fine shot but it was stopped in the field. They scampered through for the single and it was a draw.

What a game of cricket and what a great atmosphere and genuinely wonderful competitors.

Kevin Walker

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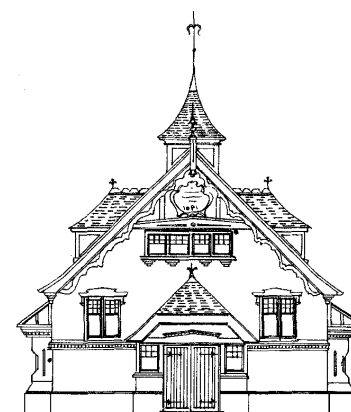
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Secretary – Mike Benson secretary@micklehamchoral.org.uk

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will@micklehamhallfarm.co.uk

MICKLEHAM OLD BOX HILLIANS FOOTBALL CLUB
Secretary – John Atewell 01372 374745

MICKLEHAM PARISH COUNCIL
SEE WEBSITE FOR MEETING DATES www.micklehamparishcouncil.gov.uk
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Parish Clerk – Feena Graham clerk@micklehamparishcouncil.gov.uk

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MICKLEHAM & WESTHUMBLE HORTICULTURAL SOCIETY
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www.surreycommunity.info/mwhs or davidkennington144@gmail.com

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PARISH PRIEST

The Rev'd Dr Sandra Faccini * 01372 417664
07763 488961
parishpriest@micklehamchurch.org.uk

* Main working days: Monday, Tuesday and Sunday

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cwb@micklehamchurch.org.uk

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timothymathieson@aol.com

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safeguarding@micklehamchurch.org.uk

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Annette Collinge 07809 684625
pv@micklehamchurch.org.uk

www.micklehamchurch.org.uk

For information about services for other denominations
see website pages.

Search on 'Churches Together Mole Valley'

CALENDAR OCTOBER

3	Saturday	10 am – noon	Coffee at Westhumble Chapel p2
4	SUNDAY – Harvest Thanksgiving		Children's Harvest workshop at church
		10 am	Family Service for all ages Note later start time
		11 am	Compline in church
6	Tuesday	7 pm	Thursday morning Bible Group p3
8	Thursday	11 am to 12.30 pm	First bonfire build day p27 for times and further dates
10	Saturday	from 10 am	
11	SUNDAY – Eighteenth Sunday after Trinity		BCP Holy Communion at Westhumble Chapel
		8 am	Holy Communion
		10 am	Bonfire building day p27
		2 pm	
Deadline for November MPM			
12	Monday	7.45 to 9 pm	Monday evening Bible Study Group p2
17	Saturday	9 to 10 am	Women's breakfast at Stepping Stones pub p2
		10 am	Bonfire building day p27
18	SUNDAY – Sunday last after Trinity		Holy Communion
		10 am	Bonfire building day p27
		2 pm	
19	Monday	3 pm	Tea@3 p2
20	Tuesday	7 pm	Compline in church
21	Wednesday	7.30 pm	WRA meeting at Westhumble Chapel
22	Thursday	12.45 for 1 pm	Autumn lunch at MVH p3
24	Saturday	9 to 10 am	Men's breakfast at Stepping Stones pub p2
		10 am	Bonfire building day p27
25	SUNDAY – Fifth Sunday before Advent		BCP Holy Communion at Westhumble Chapel
		8 am	Holy Communion
		10 am	Bonfire building day p27
		2 pm	

Dates for your diary

Monday 2 nd November	Celebration of the life of Barry Moughton at church
Saturday 7 th November	Westhumble bonfire
Sunday 8 th November	Remembrance Service in church, two minutes silence by the war memorial, then refreshments at RGS-Surrey Hills The Sounds of War and Peace Mickleham Choral Society Lights to Remember Service Autumn lunch
Sunday 15 th November	
Thursday 26 th November	

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Mark Day	07852 117249 mickleham@hotmail.com
Denise Darling	07780 673372 denisedarling4@btinternet.com
Andy Diamond	07789 775354 adiamond714@gmail.com
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Mary Banfield 01372 373912 mgbbmw@aol.com
Frances Presley 01306 882473 jasempres@gmail.com

*More helpers needed – please contact
Frances if you can spare some time.*

REGISTER

WEDDING

Friday 22nd August Keelan Hartnett and Jade Butcher



Community Directory

Continued from page 13

MICKLEHAM AND WESTHUMBLE LOCAL HISTORY GROUP

Chairman – Roger Davis 07759 042406
rogermdavis@icloud.com or www.micklehamwesthumblehistory.co.uk

MOLE VALLEY DISTRICT COUNCIL

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councillor.budleigh@molevalley.gov.uk
Cllr Abhiram Magesh 07765 126399
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Cllr Leah Mursaleen-Plank 07803 353352
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Leatherhead – Beverley Mehta 01372 374304

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Lead Co-ordinator – David Allbeury 07860 227451
westhumble.neighbourhood.watch@gmail.com

WESTHUMBLE RESIDENTS' ASSOCIATION

Chair - Chris Budleigh 07801 520059
chris.budleigh@btinternet.com

WHATSAPP GROUP

Neil MacKay nlpm@lineone.net

ADDITIONAL CONTACT INFORMATION

CITIZENS ADVICE

Dorking – Lyons Court 01306 732302
Leatherhead – Swan Mews High Street 01306 732301

CRIMESTOPPERS

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Holly Flynn *07917 434566

*Parent/partner's mobile number

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Roger Norminton

Roger was born in Halifax, Yorkshire, but when he was just three months old, he flew to Kenya with his mother and sister Jackie, to join his father who was posted there with the RAF. He had a wonderful childhood in Kenya; and Africa became such an important part of who he was, and he carried those memories with him throughout his life. Roger eventually left Kenya to go and work for Greenall Whitley selling wine and spirits all over the world. On one of his business trips he met his future wife to be, Sharon, an air hostess, and fell head over heels for her. Greenall Whitley supplied the miniatures to the airline Sharon worked for and in November of 1976, she, along with a coach load of cabin crew were invited to the distillery for a tour. It was then that Roger plucked up the courage to ask her out, and they were married less than a year later, in August 1977.

They lived in Hong Kong for a year, before returning to the UK, and began their journey as landlords by taking on

the wine bar in Hurstpierpoint. They moved on to The New Inn in Hurstpierpoint, The Plough in Henfield, The Three Horseshoes in Sidlow and finally, The Stepping Stones in Westhumble, from where they retired in 2012. Roger continued as a chef at various local hostleries including some time as breakfast chef at The Running Horses in Mickleham until dementia began to take hold.

Eventually, it became too difficult for him to remain safely at home, and his family had to make the incredibly difficult decision to move him into a care home and Roger went to Downsvalle, in Pixham Lane. The staff at Downsvalle were truly remarkable and they treated him with kindness, patience and dignity right until the very end. They cared for him as a person, and his family will always be grateful for the compassion they showed him.

Roger and Sharon had two daughters, Nikki and Joanna, of whom he was

immensely proud. They, in turn, gave him 6 wonderful grandchildren whom he adored. After a lifetime filled with adventure, friendship, travel, love and stories, Roger's final moments were surrounded by his family and enveloped in love.

Roger was an adventurer, a sailor, a fisherman, a golfer, a landlord, a fantastic story teller and, above all, a wonderful dad, husband, grandad, brother and son. He will be sadly missed by his family and his many friends.

Andy Diamond



Community News

Frances Presley writes:

Not everyone has the good fortune to have three rectors at a special birthday lunch (90 years young, would you believe? Ed), and not everyone has the good fortune to have them say Grace before the meal began. However before Grace was said we were all given the chance to have a performance of a poem/song that had us all falling off our chairs with laughter. Thank you so much Sandra, David and David for setting the feeling of happiness for the whole afternoon.



I would like to take this opportunity to thank everyone for the many, many lovely cards I received, a constant reminder of a very special celebration.

Frances Presley

A reminder:

There is to be Memorial Service and Interment of Ashes on Monday 2nd November at 11.30 am for Barry Moughton.



Congratulations to parents Georgia Venner and Tommy McMahon of Mickleham on the arrival of Laurie Joe McMahon, born on 22nd August.

Chasubles, Stoles, and Copes

I am ashamed to say that I had never heard of Froyle until Anne Weaver told us that her son-in-law was the vicar at St Mary's Church there, and they had the most interesting collection of vestments. As some of us had recently been repairing and updating vestments in Mickleham, the Westhumble and Mickleham Local History Group thought it would be a very good idea to ask to go and see them.

That is why about twenty of us found ourselves being very warmly welcomed into St Mary's with coffee and cake and an invitation to look at the vestments that had already been placed around the pews. There has been a church on that site for more than 1,000 years, the

original one being mentioned in the Domesday Book, and the present one was built between 1300 and 1350. It is just beautiful with the most stunning stained glass windows, but this is really about the vestments - so please go and see it for yourself.

First of all we were given a short history as to how they had come to be in the church at all. In the early 20th century the last Lord of the Manor, Sir Hubert Miller, who spent six months in his house in Venice and liked to travel and to collect 'things'. He seemed to have had a taste for collecting vestments in his travels, mostly from Italy and France, which he would bring back to Froyle, maybe out of a desire to add a touch of Venetian beauty back to his Hampshire parish. He then 'shoved' them into the many drawers around the church. I use that word 'shove' advisedly as that is how, about 194 in all, chasubles, stoles, copes, maniples, dalmatics and veils, were found over twenty years ago pushed into drawers and wrapped in newspapers along with mice droppings, moths and dust.

A dedicated team, the Froyle Textile Group, now spends each Wednesday caring for all the items. Each one has its own drawer in special new metal cabinets and is laid flat with cotton covers topped up with acid-free tissue paper.

Looking round all the items was truly 'mind-boggling', sadly we can only give a few examples here, and the photos are not able to show the finess that is needed to create the shading and detail of the embroidery.

The photos show the chancel with the amazing stained-glass window, a chasuble and the way fine embroidery stitches bring out the delicate changes in colour, and a dalmatic which is made of 'cloth of gold garnet'. It is easy to pick out the dark patches of the garnets which glowed deep red in the sunlight. I have taken information from the leaflets in the church regarding the vestments, and we must give a very big thank you to Anne Weaver for not only the idea to go to Froyle, but also for all



the help and advice she has given me. I would also like to thank Jane, Madeline, Jan, Jenny, Sarah and Karen who answered all our many, many questions. Frances Presley

Please see captions for the photos opposite on page 19.

Insects in the Home

More particularly insects in my home!

Many of us are probably afflicted by clothes moths, *Tineola bisselliella* in the home from time to time. I have carpets nibbled by them in every carpeted room in the house bar one. The patches are next to the skirting boards with smaller patches out in the open. This despite sprinkling powder and squirting spray. The moths seem to especially be drawn to places where our previous elderly cat pee-ed against the skirting boards. It seems I did not clean up thoroughly enough!

This summer I tried a biological control, sachets of parasitic wasp eggs, *Trichogramma avanescens*. The eggs, which come in a small paper sachet with a tiny exit hole, hatch and the minute, 0.5mm, non-stinging wasps lay their eggs in the eggs of the clothes moths and thus prevent them from hatching. They do not come cheap but after two goes the moths seem to have gone. For the time being at any rate.

Less troublesome are Indian Meal moths, *Plodia interpunctella* which are somewhat larger than clothes moths and darker in colour. In my house they lay their eggs in bird seed but they also favour flour, cereals and similar products. The eggs hatch into tiny caterpillar like grubs which I find in the bird seed or crawling up the walls. They seem to like to pupate where the walls join the ceiling. Apart from leaving cobwebby strands in the bird seed they seem harmless enough.

Of course, we have spiders. There are lots of long legged, small bodied Cellar spiders, *Pholcus phalangoides* and their cobwebs. The occasional big, dark specimen of the Giant House spider, *Tegonaria gigantea* runs across the carpet or turns up in the baths. We also have a few ruddy brown ones which, I think, may be False Widow spiders, *Steatoda nobilis*.

Black Garden ants, *Lasius niger* are regular visitors in small numbers. They don't seem to be after anything in particular. It seems they have just wandered in. Perhaps they are just exploring and return to the nest with nothing much to report.

Despite recent, major renovations or perhaps because of, Silverfish, *Lepisma saccharinum* scuttle along the bottom of the skirting boards once in a while. They are a very primitive, wingless insect, and part of a group known as the bristletails. They live in houses, where they feed on sugar and starch, which can be found in paper, soap residues and even dust. They particularly like slightly damp places so they are most likely to be seen in bathrooms or kitchens.

We have a variety of flies that buzz about in the summer. Big blue bottles, *Calliphora vomitoria* (Nice name that!) get swatted with a funeral order of service which is just the right size and stiffness to serve as fly swat. We hope Herb would be amused. Smaller species receive the same treatment.

In the sunroom, where I have several house plants, and in the adjoining



Indian Meal Moth
© Kaldari, public domain

sitting room, we sometimes get a plague of tiny, black flies that fly around our heads or crawl on horizontal surfaces. These are fungus gnats of which there are many species in five different families. They breed in damp soil or compost. Numbers abate or they disappear if I reduce watering from on top of the growing medium and water mostly from below.

Lastly, once in a while, in one of the bathrooms there appears what look like small black moths. They are actually drain or sewer flies, *Clogmia altipunctata* and despite their common name are another harmless visitor to the home. As their name implies they breed in drains and sewers. What have you got in your house, I wonder?

Barbara Jones

Captions for photos on pages 18 and 19

Page 18 top right and top left: Views of the east window, also shows the repaired roof following visitations by several generations of jackdaws

Page 19 left and right: Chasuble with embroidery detail

Opposite left and right: Chasuble and embroidery detail made from cloth of gold and garnets

Opposite page top right: Members of the group enjoying coffee and cake on arrival at the church



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Memorial for David Ottridge



On a sunny morning in June, a good
number of us assembled in the
recreation ground in Mickleham to
dedicate a bench to the memory of
David Ottridge.

David and his wife Mari lived in Dell
Close for many years, during which he,
assisted on occasion by Mari, served as
responsible finance officer on the parish
council. This role involves managing the
complicated financial arrangements of
the parish council, which arrangements
become ever more complicated as
governments think of new ways to make
life difficult. David managed this role with

a light touch, and it was a measure of his
popularity, and the respect in which he
was held, that more people showed up
for this event that had showed up for
the previous week for our annual parish
meeting; and that attendance was of
itself a record.

The bench had been commissioned by the
parish council, funded jointly by the parish
council and Mari, manufactured locally
and installed by our very own Jason and
Gill Wilson, so is entirely a local product.
It is situated on the south-western corner
of the Rec, looking up towards the house
where David and Mari and their family

spent so many happy years.

It was lovely to see Mari, her son Luke
and her granddaughter Kiah cut the tape
and ceremoniously sit on the bench for
the first time. We presented Mari with a
bunch of flowers - many thanks to Feena
Graham - which, Mari noted, perfectly
matched her pink outfit.

We hope many of you will take the
opportunity to take a moment out of
your busy lives to sit and remember
David, who gave so many years of his
life to serving the community in which
we are privileged to live.

Will Dennis



Friday 30th October
9.30 am to 12.30 pm

Chapel Farm
Westhumble RH5 6AY

You are invited to our annual coffee
morning in aid of Macmillan Cancer
Support. Please come along, bring some
friends, and have a cuppa and some
cake, enjoy the gardens and say hello

Chapel Farm Macmillan Coffee Morning

to the animals. There will be lots of
treats to eat and take-aways available
for the weekend. If you have not been
before it will be lovely to welcome you
to Chapel Farm.

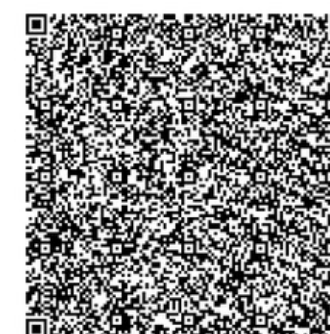
If you support us regularly, thank you,
and I look forward to welcoming you
back to the farm. We raised an amazing
£1,433 last year and we would love to
continue supporting this wonderful
charity. It is particularly relevant to us as
a family this year as my darling husband
was diagnosed with advanced prostate
cancer earlier in the summer.

We all know someone who has been
supported by Macmillan and it is great

to be able to continue raising funds for
them while catching up with friends
and enjoying a cuppa. If you are unable
to come along on the day and wish to
support the event there is a link to a
JustGiving page below for this coffee
morning.

Thank you to my lovely friends, family
and neighbours for your support. I look
forward to seeing you next month.

With love Liz Absalom
07801 791123



Do come along to help with bonfire building in
October. Meet new people and learn a new skill
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See page 27.

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A Visit to Wallington's Nurseries

In early August, The Garden Shed arranged a visit to several nurseries in the Wallington area. Although the day did not go quite to plan, it provided an interesting insight into the area's long association with growing plants and produce.

We visited a nursery that propagates and grows its own plants, reducing the need to rely on outside suppliers. At Sutton Community Garden, we heard about a very different model, with vegetables grown for sale to the public, supported largely by volunteers. The garden also hosts various activities throughout the year. Just a short drive away, Evergreen Wholesalers supplies plants and trees, both large and small, mainly to landscape gardeners.

The area is home to a surprising number of independent nurseries, including the well known Lavender Farm. There is a fascinating historical reason for this concentration. After the First World War, returning servicemen were offered

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Any questions

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homes and land at Little Woodcote, with encouragement to grow their own produce. Some of the original wooden houses can still be seen today.

The fertile land was recognised as suitable for growing crops even then,

and this tradition has continued. Today's nurseries may look very different from those early plots, but they remain part of Wallington's horticultural heritage and help explain why the area continues to be such a productive place for growing.

Fish Rescue

The Environment Agency rescued over 2,000 stranded fish on the River Mole in Surrey during the severe August 2026 drought conditions.

The rescue was required due to extended high temperatures and minimal rainfall. It caused a three-mile stretch of the river between Dorking and Leatherhead (near Norbury Park) to dry up. The natural chalk geology caused sections of the river to disappear underground, trapping fish in shrinking, low-oxygen pools. Officers used safe electric fishing equipment to

temporarily stun the fish so they could collect them in nets without harm. The captured fish were placed into oxygen-rich, insulated transport tanks filled with cool water. Hundreds of fish were moved safely and released into deeper, healthier sections upstream that were more resilient against drying out.

Rescued Species: Larger fish: chub up to 3 lb, pike up to 5 lb, and barbel up to 2 lb. Smaller fish: Healthy numbers of bream, tench, roach, dace, perch, gudgeon, stone loach, and minnows.

Source: Environment Agency website



Photo from the September issue showing Ben Tatham and his daughter Jenny surveying the dried up Mole.

Halloween Ghost Walks

Join us for a historic Halloween Ghost Walk to celebrate the spookiest time of year! Meet the ghosts of Dorking whose spirits are said to haunt the town: the boy soldier, the murdered monk, the drunken duke, and the murdered

policeman. Saturday 31st October, walks at 6 pm and 7.30 pm from St. Martin's Churchyard, Dorking. Please see <http://dorkingmuseum.org.uk/guided-walks-around-dorking/> for details and booking.



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As another new academic year begins, we thought it was a lovely time to say hello to the wider Mickleham community and share a little glimpse of life at St Michael's Community Nursery.

For many of our children, starting nursery is the beginning of a very special journey. It is a time of first friendships, new experiences, growing independence and lots of wonderful discoveries. Our aim is to make those early experiences as happy and positive as possible, creating a place where children feel safe, valued and excited to come through the door each morning.

We are incredibly lucky to be part of the Mickleham community. Our village

and the beautiful surroundings provide a wonderful backdrop to the children's learning, and we make the most of them whenever we can. There is always something to notice and explore, from watching the seasons change and spotting birds and minibeasts, to growing plants or simply enjoying being outside together. A walk around the village can become an adventure, a conversation or the starting point for a whole new learning experience!

We also feel strongly that children benefit from feeling part of their local community. Mickleham has such a wonderful sense of belonging, and we are grateful for the many ways in which the village welcomes and supports our young children. These connections help children understand that they are part of something bigger and that their contribution matters. There is something very special about watching a child grow during their time at nursery, seeing friendships develop, confidence blossom and independence grow. Please do say hello when you see us out and about!

Back at nursery, our days are filled with stories, songs, creative activities, imaginative play, building, puzzles and endless opportunities to ask questions and investigate. For young children, play really is at the heart of learning. Through play, they learn to share ideas, solve problems, communicate, try something new and, perhaps most importantly, develop the confidence to have a go.

As we look forward to the year ahead, we are excited about everything still to come, new friendships, questions to answer, stories to share and plenty of adventures along the way.

Starting nursery can be just as big a milestone for parents and carers as it is for their children. We are privileged to work alongside our families during these important early years and greatly appreciate their trust and support.

Thank you to everyone in Mickleham who helps make our nursery such a special part of the village.

Hilary Budd



Autumn Exhibition at Denbies Wine Estate 9 - 11th October

Open to the public Friday 9th October and Saturday 10th October 10 am to 5 pm

Sunday 11th October 10 am to 4 pm

Entrance to the exhibition is free.

For more information email contact@dga.org.uk

The Dorking Group of artists welcomes everyone of any artistic ability to join a forward thinking and lively group to exchange ideas and skills and meet with like-minded and friendly people.



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Westhumble Bonfire and Fireworks

Saturday 7th November in Westhumble Field

(w3w ///friend.table.olive)

Building the bonfire will begin on 10th October. Lots of new helpers needed. Learn bonfire-building skills from the more experienced members of the team and ensure that this very popular community event can continue! Everyone is welcome for any amount of time. Refreshments will be available.
Bring wellies and thick gloves.

Please remember that a bonfire is a dangerous place even before it is lit, so please keep small children and pets under supervision.

BONFIRE BUILDING

Saturday 10th Oct from 10 am	Sunday 11th Oct from 2 pm
Saturday 17th Oct from 10 am	Sunday 18th Oct from 2 pm
Saturday 24th Oct from 10 am	Sunday 25th Oct from 2 pm

Finishing touches as required in the weekends that follow

Please bring material for the bonfire to the site, BUT NOT BEFORE Sun 11th October. No yew wood or timber with SCREWS or NAILS, as these are dangerous to animals. No rubbish please. Ideally, sections of wood or branches, as opposed to piles of greenery and leaf clippings.

Torchlight procession at 5.15 pm from junction of Burney Road, Chapel Lane and Adlers Lane

Bonfire lighting at 6 pm **Fireworks from 6.30 pm**

All from Mickleham & Westhumble welcome along with relatives and friends.
The charge per person can be kept down if more people attend. We are asking for £10 per head for adults and £5 for children at the entrance to the field.
Sausages will be available from the BBQ, alongside other food and drink as per last year.






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Hidden Words/ Hidden Birds

Can you find 26 birds hidden in the story below? Some are spread over two or more words.

A Trip to the Theme Park

Last week we went to the theme park. We took a picnic. John brought along a cake he'd baked in the microwave.

As we went in, we were confronted by giant figures in fancy dress. Some were on stilts. A brown bear growled in a friendly greeting. Bob the Builder had his tools with him – hammer, saw and wrench. A tall ogre beguiled us with serenades while ducking under the overhanging branches of the trees.

Of course, we had to ride on the big dipper. I worried it might come off the rails. It was almost as bad as being on a yacht at night in gale force winds. Sally

quailed at the very idea and went for a stroll on her mobility scooter instead. Jane was nervous but we got her on alright.

Edward had brought his kite along so we found an open space to fly it. He swiftly had it so high that it tangled with a nearby crane and the knot securing the string came adrift. 'Oh, you twit, Edward, it will be there for eternity,' said John. But then, Mike shimmied up the jib and had it down in a trice. 'Gosh, awkward or what,' commented Jane.

Then we had a stint at roller skating. Mike grouched that his skates were too small and he nearly fell in the brook that ran alongside the rink.

The café tea left something to be desired but we all agreed the day had given us a buzz, arduous though it had been.



Birds seen by the lake in Petworth Park.

Have you found the following?

rook teal, buzzard. 26
tern, goshawk, hen, stilt, roller, grouse,
heron, kite, swift, crane, knot, twite,
dipper, rail, nightingale, quail, coot,
Crow, stilt, owl, wren, grebe, duck,

Compiled by Barbara Jones



Family Activities in October at Dorking Library

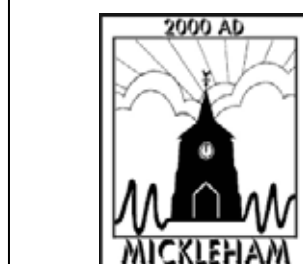
Autumn Magic Craft Extravaganza: What will you create to celebrate the colours of Autumn? Will it be a pinecone hedgehog? Or a conker cobweb? In conjunction with Arts Society Dorking, as a part of Arts Alive. Saturday 10th October, 10am to 2pm.

Family Learning Festival: Come and play a classic game with your family during half term. Did your family play the same games? Tuesday 20th October, 10 am to 2pm. Dorking Library, St Martin's Walk. Free, materials provided and children must be accompanied.



Over the years we have received regular information from David Burton at Dorking Museum about activities at the museum which will be of interest to our readers and particularly their children. David is cutting back the work he does for the museum and we understand that he will no longer be responsible for links with parish magazines. The editors are grateful to David: he has been such a regular contributor for ages and never complains if we are unable to find space for his material. Thank you, David.

Welcome to Laura who will be our contact in future.



MICKLEHAM PARISH COUNCIL

Meeting Dates
2026-2027

Full Council Meetings

Start 7.30 pm

Ranmore Room,

St Michael's Church

Wednesday 11th November at 8 pm
2027

Wednesday 27th January

Wednesday 10th March

Details of agendas/minutes will be available on the website.

www.micklehamparishcouncil.gov.uk

Anyone wishing to attend or raise any issues please email:

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